IoTivity–an open source framework to set standards for the IoT sector

Internet-connected devices are proliferating, yet standards have still not been set for the IoT sector. To address this issue, an open source software framework has been developed, called IoTivity. The framework has launched its Preview Release too. The Linux Foundation is hosting the open source framework, and it will release a reference implementation of IoT standards.

These standards have been defined by the Open Internet Consortium or OIC, which has members like Intel and Samsung. The framework is aimed at providing standards implementation for devices and services following an open source policy. The devices and services will be able to cooperate with each other, irrespective of who is using them.

IoTivity is a Linux Foundation project; so quite obviously, it is being supervised by an independent steering group, in collaboration with OIC. In order to get involved with the project, developers can access RESTful-based APIs and also submit code so that peer review is allowed. The code submission is allowed through the project's Gerrit server. It will be made available across many programming languages, along with operating systems and hardware platforms.

The Azure cloud migration tool now gets Linux support!

In October, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella created a huge buzz in the tech industry by announcing that, "Microsoft loves Linux!" Now the statement is getting further backing with a new offering, using which organisations will be able to migrate their Linux servers and virtual machines (VMs) to the Microsoft Azure cloud service.

In a blog post, Srinath Vasireddy, principal lead program manager for Microsoft Cloud and Enterprise, announced, "Today, we are excited to add support for the migration of Linux physical and virtual machines to Azure. This functionality will further bolster the support for heterogeneity in MA [Migration Accelerator]." With Migration Accelerator, organisations will be able to transfer physical and virtual server workloads to the cloud.

The Windows server-only preview of Migration Accelerator was launched in September last year, and at that time Vasireddy had said it was designed to migrate physical, VMware, Amazon Web Services and Microsoft Hyper-V workloads into Azure, seamlessly. The migration process gets automated with this technology too. Now the Redmond-based tech giant has added support for CentOS Linux 6.4 and 6.5, with Oracle Linux 6.4 and 6.5. The company says that the MA supports a single OS system disk due to certain limitations in Azure. (You can refer to the original blog by Srinath Vasireddy to get detailed information about the new announcement.)

Customers will also find it easier to move existing workloads to another Azure data centre, as a previous blog post by Guy Bowerman, senior program manager of Microsoft Azure Compute Runtime, said, "The solution, aptly named Azure Data Centre Migration Solution (ADCMS) and licensed under Apache v2.0, provides a highly flexible and extensible method of moving assets from one Azure data centre to another."

Fedora 22 will be released on time, sacrificing GCC 5

With Fedora 22 scheduled for release in mid-May this year, but the GCC 5 (GNU Collection of Compilers) out only in March, there was some speculation about whether Fedora 22 would be delayed in order to incorporate the latest version of GCC. Fedora has a reputation for its releases incorporating the bleeding edge, yet it also suffers from being known for delayed release dates. To address these difficulties, the Fedora Engineering and Steering Committee (FESCo) convened an urgent meeting and the outcome has astonished many in the community.

The committee has decided not to head for a mass-rebuild of the Fedora packages (something that would be required if it incorporated GCC 5, since the current Fedora packages are based on GCC 4.9) as the Fedora 22 schedule does not permit that. A time-based schedule seems preferred by FESCo this time, at the expense of Fedora's earlier track record of always trying to incorporate the latest features in its newest releases.

Some other Fedora 22 feature proposals have also been cancelled at the convention, which would require the mass-rebuild of the Fedora packages. The cancelled proposals include hardening all the packages with a position-independent code.

Many Fedora lovers are against the concept of Fedora 22 shipping without the latest compiler. FESCo, too, would have preferred going with GCC 5, but that would have required pushing F22 to a summer release and, as per its six-month timeline, that would affect Fedora 23 also, postponing the latter till the Thanksgiving and Christmas season, which would invite more difficulties for developers and the entire team. The rhythm followed in Fedora releases is May and October. The meeting concluded that there would be no break in the schedule, and that Fedora 22 will be out in mid-May, as planned.